

TOPIC 8: IMPORTANCE OF TAJWID

1. Benefits of Correct Recitation

Reciting the Qur'an with proper Tajwid brings many spiritual, educational, and practical benefits:

- **Preservation of the Qur'an:** Correct Tajwid ensures that the words of Allah are pronounced exactly as they were revealed, protecting the meaning from distortion.
- **Increased Reward:** The Prophet (peace be upon him) said that the one who recites the Qur'an skilfully will be in the company of the noble and righteous scribes (angels).
- **Better Understanding:** Proper pronunciation helps the listener and the reciter grasp the correct meaning of the verses.
- **Spiritual Connection:** Beautiful and correct recitation softens the heart, increases concentration (khushu'), and brings the reciter closer to Allah.
- **Fulfilment of a Religious Duty:** Learning and applying Tajwid is considered an individual obligation (Fard 'Ayn) for every Muslim who reads the Qur'an.
- **Beauty of the Qur'an:** The Qur'an is meant to be recited melodiously. Tajwid brings out its natural beauty and rhythm.

2. Role of Tajwid in Preserving the Qur'an

The Qur'an was revealed orally. From the time of the Prophet (peace be upon him) until today, Muslims have preserved it through both writing and precise oral transmission. Tajwid is the system that guarantees this oral preservation. Without Tajwid rules:

- Letters could be changed or confused (e.g., 'seen' and 'saad').
- Meanings of words and entire verses could be altered.
- The unique style and miracle of the Qur'anic language would be lost.

By teaching Tajwid from generation to generation, the Muslim Ummah has kept the Qur'an pure and unchanged for over 1,400 years – a fulfilment of Allah's promise: *'Indeed, it is We who sent down the Qur'an and indeed, We will be its guardian.'* (Qur'an 15:9)

3. Consequences of Ignoring Tajwid

- Changing the meaning of Allah's words (which can be sinful if done deliberately).
- Missing out on the full reward of recitation.
- Difficulty in being understood by other Muslims who know the correct reading.
- Weakening of one's own connection with the Qur'an.

4. Practical Advice for Students

- Start learning Tajwid early and practise daily.
- Find a qualified teacher who can correct your mistakes.
- Use audio recordings of renowned Qaris for listening practice.
- Focus on one rule at a time until it becomes natural.
- Apply the rules you learn immediately when reading any portion of the Qur'an.
- Make du'a for ease and consistency in learning.

5. Conclusion

Tajwid is not just a set of technical rules; it is a means of honouring the speech of Allah, protecting His Book, and drawing closer to Him. Every student of Islamic Religious Studies should strive to recite the Qur'an correctly, beautifully, and with understanding. May Allah make us among those who recite the Qur'an as it was revealed and who act upon its teachings. Ameen.

End of Topic 8 – Importance of Tajwid

— End of JSS 1 IRS First Term Notes —